

emerged and regional competition became an actuality where lines of different gauges crossed or paralleled one another," wrote Kerr.

He noted that independent India, in 1947, had three different types of gauges criss-crossing the countryside. There were 24,029 km of broad-gauge and 15,752 km of metre-gauge lines. The two connected at 53 trans-shipment points including the crucial Mokameh Ghat in Bihar. The third type included 2,290 km of narrow-gauge lines.



▲ This illustration from *The Illustrated London News* of 6 June 1846 depicts the commotion that would ensue as the carriage shifted gauges. Dalhousie tried to avoid this situation in India, but failed.